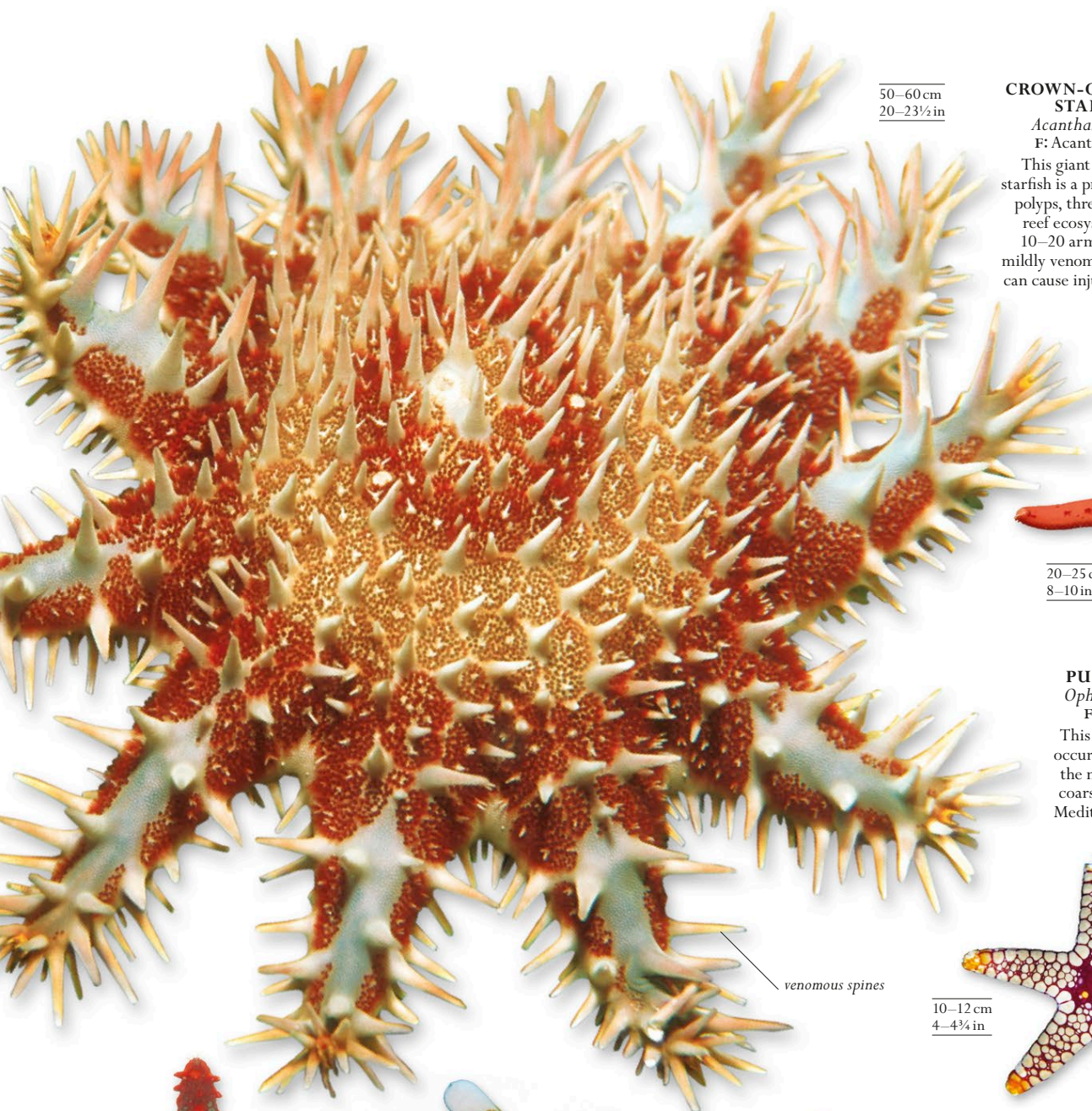




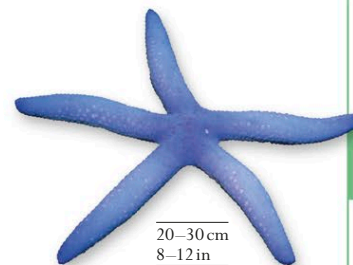
50–60 cm
20–23½ in

CROWN-OF-THORNS STARFISH

Acanthaster planci

F: Acanthasteridae

This giant Indo-Pacific starfish is a predator of coral polyps, threatening some reef ecosystems. It has 10–20 arms and sharp, mildly venomous spines that can cause injury to humans.



20–30 cm
8–12 in

BLUE STARFISH

Linckia laevigata

F: Ophidiasteridae

Snake-armed starfish have a smooth, spinesless surface. This Indo-Pacific species is usually blue, but a minority are purple or orange. It frequently lives in association with detritus-eating shrimp.



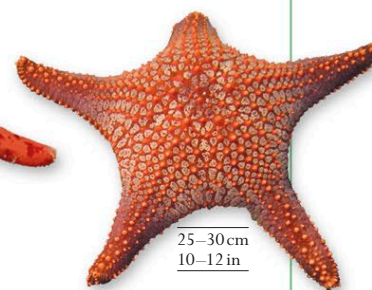
20–25 cm
8–10 in

PURPLE STARFISH

Ophidiaster ophidianus

F: Ophidiasteridae

This snake-armed starfish occurs in warmer waters of the northeast Atlantic, on coarse seabeds around the Mediterranean and as far as W. Africa.



25–30 cm
10–12 in

KNOBBLY STARFISH

Pentaceraster cumingi

F: Oreasteridae

This large strikingly patterned cushion star occurs on sandy and rubble-strewn sea bottoms of tropical central and E. Pacific.



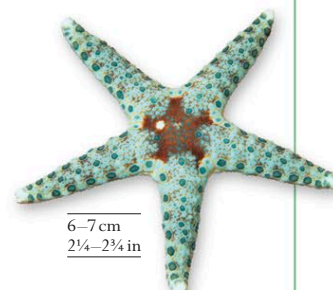
10–12 cm
4–4¾ in

NECKLACE STARFISH

Fromia monilis

F: Goniasteridae

There are 15 *Fromia* species, sometimes difficult to tell apart, but all are brightly coloured to deter predators. This common shallow-water species is widespread in the Indo-Pacific.



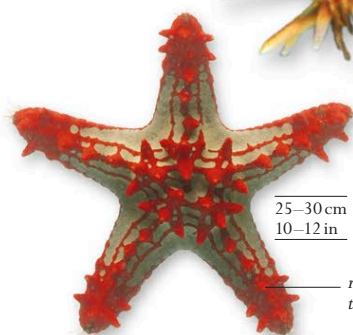
6–7 cm
2¼–2¾ in

CUMING'S PLATED STARFISH

Neoferdina cumingi

F: Goniasteridae

This Pacific species lives on shallow reefs but others in the family occur at depths below 1,000m (3,300ft). All are characterized by rows of granular plates on their upper surface.



25–30 cm
10–12 in

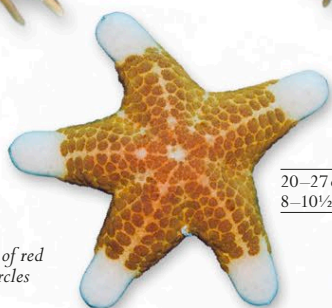
rows of red tubercles

RED GENERAL STARFISH

Protoreaster lincki

F: Oreasteridae

From the cushion star family, this Indian Ocean species grazes on algae as a juvenile, but preys on other invertebrates when adult.



20–27 cm
8–10½ in

GRANULATED STARFISH

Choriaster granulatus

F: Oreasteridae

A giant Indo-Pacific echinoderm of rubble slopes and coral reefs, this cushion star grazes on algae and detritus in shallow waters.



20–25 cm
8–10 in

INDO-PACIFIC CUSHION STAR

Culcita novaeguineae

F: Oreasteridae

This coral-feeder of the Indo-Pacific belongs to a family of starfish that become shorter-armed as they get bigger, eventually maturing into dumpy cushion shapes.



15–20 cm
6–8 in

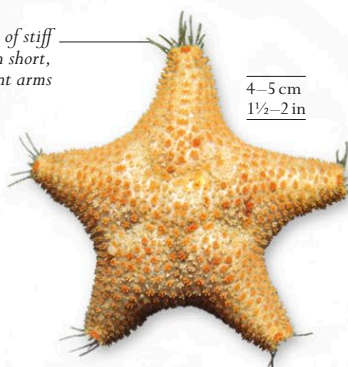
GOOSEFOOT STARFISH

Anseropoda placenta

F: Asterinidae

A thin flat starfish with ill-defined arms, the goosefoot starfish of the E. Atlantic is a predator of bottom-dwelling crustaceans.

groups of stiff spines on short, blunt arms



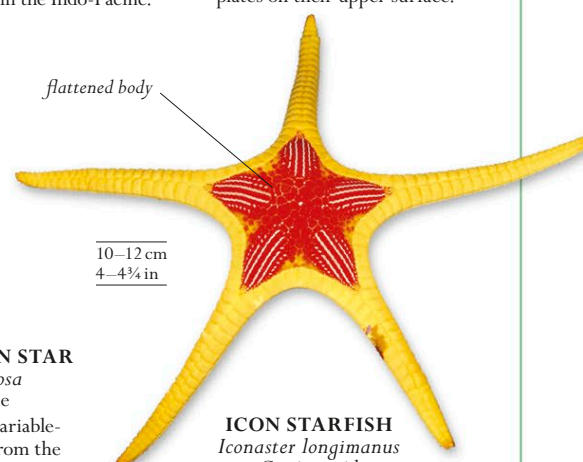
4–5 cm
1½–2 in

SMALL CUSHION STAR

Asterina gibbosa

F: Asterinidae

This short-armed variable-coloured starfish, from the same family as the goosefoot, scavenges dead material on the rocky coasts of the N.E. Atlantic.



10–12 cm
4–4¾ in

ICON STARFISH

Iconaster longimanus

F: Goniasteridae

Many echinoderms develop from planktonic larvae, but this Indo-Pacific starfish lacks a larval stage. It produces large yolky eggs.